

CEMS Application Form – Motivation Letter

PERSONAL INFORMATION

Last Name: Taube

First Name: David

Please write a one-page (not longer!) motivation letter that clearly conveys why you want to join the CEMS programme and what drives you personally and academically. Please don't just repeat your CV.

Focus especially on:

1. **Your motivation for applying to CEMS:**
What excites you about the programme? Which values, experiences, or goals connect with what CEMS offers?
2. **Key learning moments from your life:**
Choose one or two meaningful experiences – academic, professional, or personal – that shaped your ambitions, worldview, or approach to leadership. Explain what you learned and how these lessons prepare you for CEMS.
3. **Your study plan and international aspirations:**
Outline how you envision your study path within the programme and, if relevant, where you would ideally like to spend your CEMS term abroad—and why.

Aim for authenticity over formality. Show us what motivates you, what you hope to contribute to the CEMS community, and how the programme fits into your long-term goals.

CEMS Application Form – Motivation Letter**YOUR MOTIVATION LETTER**

Dear Sir or Madam,

The CEMS Master's in International Management appeals to me because it combines academic rigor with genuine international exposure and close collaboration with global companies. I am looking for a programme that goes beyond purely theoretical learning and allows students to work in diverse, international environments. The strong focus on global strategy, leadership across cultures, and practical business projects makes CEMS particularly attractive to me.

Currently, I work full-time at SAP in the Corporate Strategy (Portfolio) team. In this role, I support analyses and planning processes that contribute to strategic decision-making at Executive Board level. Being involved in this environment has shown me how complex global decision-making really is. It requires not only analytical thinking and financial understanding, but also the ability to communicate ideas clearly and translate data into actionable recommendations. This experience strengthened my ambition to work in international strategy or consulting.

An experience that shaped my mindset early on was founding a small start-up shortly after finishing school. Developing a product, organizing financing topics and presenting the idea to investors and media required persistence and ownership. I learned quickly that decisions often have to be made with limited information and that progress depends on taking responsibility rather than waiting for certainty.

Another important experience was living and working in Switzerland for a year during my studies. While studying, I worked as a tennis coach and interacted daily with people from different backgrounds. This experience strengthened my independence and adaptability. Although I have not yet completed a formal semester abroad, I have deliberately sought international environments that challenged me outside of my usual surroundings.

Within the CEMS programme, I am particularly interested in the modules on Global Strategy and Global Leadership as well as the CEMS Business Project. Working in multicultural teams on real business challenges reflects the environment in which I would like to develop further. For my term abroad, I would ideally choose ESSEC Business School. Having spent time in France during my school years, I developed an early interest in the language and culture. Studying at ESSEC would allow me to deepen my French skills and experience another European academic environment.

In the long term, I aim to work in international strategy consulting or corporate strategy within a global organization. CEMS represents an opportunity to further develop the analytical skills, international perspective, and sense of responsibility that such a path requires.

To sum up, CEMS aligns closely with my academic ambitions and professional aspirations. I would value the opportunity to develop further within a community that brings together students from many different cultures and professional backgrounds.

Sincerely,
David Taube